Theme:	HANSEL & GRETEL (Safety & hiking in the veld)	

Date: 22 May 2026 Duty Six: Yellow

Time	Min	Activity	Equipment	Scouter
18h00	10	**GRAND HOWL** Flag Register Break	Totem/skin/ Flag/flag pole Register	Akela Six
Tonight we going to hear the story of Hansel and Gretel and how they got lost in the thick woods. How prepared are you as cubs and chums if we had to go on a hike now?				
18h10	5	**Inspection:** Anything that can be useful if you going on a hike that you can use. i.e. cap, first aid kit, scarves, rope, safety pin, water bottle, whistle, etc.	Bones Bone bags	All
Hansel and Gretel were brother and sister and they had each other as buddies all the time. What is one of the most important rules of being a cub?				
18h15	5	**STEAM RELEASE: Buddies** Cubs run around in a free formation. When the leader calls "Buddies" Cubs find a partner and sit.	None	Kaa
The poor woodcutter loved his children very much, but his new wife was very bossy and told him that he needed to get rid of the children as they did not have enough food to feed them all. The woodcutter's wife insisted that he needed to take the children far into the woods so that they get lost and could not return back home.				
18h20	15	**Advancement Discussion Part 1: Outdoors Challenge GW** Explain what to do if you get lost in the veld: STOP Discuss natural dangers you may find in the veld.	Discussion Notes	ALL
The children heard their step-mother telling their dad that he needs to lose them in the woods the next day. Poor Hansel and Gretel - lost in the deep dark forest. The birds have eaten their breadcrumb trail, and the witch is trying to confuse everyone. Each Six must become a rescue team. Carry the rescue signal through the forest, collect pebbles, and build a safe trail home before the witch catches up.				
18h35	10	**TEAM GAME: Rescue** **Step over the fallen logs** – sticks on the ground **Crawl through the brambles** – under a chair **Hop across the stepping stones** – hula hoops **Dodge the witch's trees** – weave through chairs **Reach the rescue tree** – chair at the far end On "Go!", they carry the ball through The Dark Forest. When they reach the far end, they collect one pebble (beanbag) and un back. When they get back, they must throw the ball to the next Cub in their Six. The next Cub may only start once they have caught the ball. If they drop it, the thrower must try again. After throwing successfully, the first Cub sits down	Balls Chairs Bean bags Sticks Hula hoops	Rikki

		at the back of the line. The winning Six is the first to have all Cubs sitting down with their collected pebbles.		
Hansel and Gretel became lost in the woods they tried to find their way home. They walked through the entire day and night but they could not find their way out of the woods. This was very tiring, and they were getting hungry and thirsty. Hansel found a little stream and drank so of the cool sweet water.				
18h45	5	**Water Break**	None	All
Hansel and Gretel came upon a little house that was built entirely from bread, with roof made of cake, and the windows were made of clear sugar. Yum yum!				
18h50	5	**Yarn: Hansel & Gretel**	Yarn sheet	Raksha
Cubs and Chums are so lucky that your parents love you with all their hearts and soul that they won't take you into the woods to get you lost. Now if you are going on a hike it always better to be prepared.				
19h00	21	**Advancement Discussion Part 2: Outdoors** **Challenge GW (7 minute rotations):** Shouting (cooee) & Blowing a whistle Using a mirror to reflect the sun (use a torch) Using materials to write the word HELP (have the cubs do this using jerseys or their bodies)	Whistle Mirror Discussion Notes	All
19h21	4	**Tidy up** **Collect of Bones** **Notices: Night Hike, Snake visit** **Badges**		All
19h25	5	**GRAND HOWL** Flag Down Prayer Dismiss	Totem/skin/ Flag/flag pole Prayer book	Akela Six
CHUMS Promise and law: Motto		**GOLD WOLF** Outdoor challenge: Explain what to do if you get lost in the veld. Discuss the natural dangers you may find in the veld. Demonstrate three ways of making distress signals.		

Getting lost in the veld: STOP

S – Stop

As soon as you realise you are lost, stop walking. Do not run, wander, or "just try one more path". Moving around makes it harder for adults or rescue helpers to find you. Take a few slow breaths and stay calm.

T – Think

Ask yourself: "Where was the last place I saw the group?" "Can I hear voices, traffic, water, or a whistle? "Is there a safe open space nearby?" "What do I have with me: water, whistle, jacket, hat?"

Do not eat wild plants, berries, mushrooms, or unknown fruit. Do not drink from streams unless an adult has told you it is safe or the water has been treated.

O – Observe

Look around carefully without moving far. Check for landmarks such as a hill, fence, path, river, big rock, gate, power line, or building. Also observe the weather, shade, wind, insects, animals, and whether there is any fire or smoke nearby. Choose a safe waiting place: visible, open, sheltered from extreme sun or wind, and away from cliffs, rivers, animal holes, thick bush, and burnt or burning areas.

P – Plan
Make a simple safety plan: Stay where you are unless there is immediate danger. Make yourself visible with bright clothing, a hat, backpack, or scarf. Use your whistle or voice in bursts: three blasts/shouts is a common distress signal. Stay warm or cool depending on the weather. Conserve energy and water. Wait for help.
A good rule is: "Hug a tree" or stay next to a clear landmark. It gives you a safe place to wait and makes you easier to find.

Natural dangers in the veld:

Weather and temperature
The veld can get very hot during the day and cold later, especially if the weather changes. Heat can cause dehydration, sunburn, and heat exhaustion; cold, wet, and wind can cause chilling. Hiking safety guidance also warns about fatigue, hypothermia, dehydration, and heat exhaustion as real hiking risks.
Prevention: wear a hat, use sunscreen, drink water, carry a warm top or rain jacket, and stay with the group.

Veld fires
Dry grass, wind, and heat can make veld fires spread quickly. SCOUTS South Africa's Safety Code badge specifically expects Scouts to understand the dangers of veld fires and precautions when camping or hiking.
Prevention: never play with matches or lighters, only make fires where adults say it is safe, and report smoke or flames immediately.

Snakes, insects, spiders, ticks, and scorpions
Most creatures will avoid people, but they may bite or sting if stepped on, picked up, or trapped.
Prevention: watch where you walk, do not put hands into holes or under rocks, shake out shoes, wear closed shoes, and tell an adult if bitten or stung.

Thorny plants and poisonous plants
The veld may have thorns, burrs, stinging plants, and plants that are unsafe to eat.
Prevention: do not eat wild plants unless a knowledgeable adult says they are safe, and do not push through thick bush unnecessarily.

Rivers, streams, dams, and flash floods
Water can look shallow but be slippery, fast, or deeper than expected. If a river is in flood and dangerous, the safe choice is to wait rather than cross.
Prevention: never cross water without adult instruction, and stay away from flooded streams.

Rocks, holes, slopes, and uneven ground
Loose stones, animal burrows, dongas, cliffs, and slippery ground can cause falls or sprains.
Prevention: walk, do not run; stay on the path; and look where you put your feet.

Larger animals and livestock
Cattle, dogs, baboons, warthogs, antelope, and other animals can be dangerous if surprised, cornered, or protecting young.
Prevention: keep your distance, do not feed animals, and never chase or tease them.

Once upon a muddy time,
In a cottage full of grime,
Lived two small children, thin as twigs,
With empty plates and hungry rigs.

Their names were Hansel, Gretel too,
And not much food was in their stew.
A crumb of bread, a sniff of cheese,
A cabbage leaf, some ancient peas.

Their father sighed, "We're in a pickle.
Our soup is mostly spoon and trickle."
Their stepmum said, "Well, here's my plan:
We'll lose them in the woods. We can!"

Now Hansel heard this dreadful plot
While lying on his lumpy cot.
He whispered, "Gretel, don't you weep.
I've got a plan. Pretend to sleep."

That night he crept outside with care
And found some pebbles, smooth and fair.
He filled his pockets, left and right,
Then climbed back in and hugged them tight.

Next morning, with a cheerful grin,
Their stepmum said, "Let's all go in
The lovely woods for fresh air, dears!"
Which somehow didn't calm their fears.

They walked past trees with twisted knees,
Past buzzing flies and grumpy bees.
And every few steps Hansel dropped
A shiny stone, then quickly stopped.

At last their parents said, "You stay.
We'll chop some wood not far away."
But off they went, without a sound,
And left the children on the ground.

When moonlight made the pebbles glow,
Said Hansel, "Right then. Off we go."
They followed stones back through the night,
And reached their door by morning light.

Their father gasped. Their stepmum frowned.
"How very odd you both were found."
But soon she planned another trick,
This time more sneaky, mean, and slick.

Poor Hansel, locked inside all night,
Could gather no small stones of white.
So when they went back through the trees,
He dropped fresh breadcrumbs in the breeze.

But birds, as birds are known to do,
Said, "Breakfast! Lunch! And supper too!"
They gobbled every crumb with glee,
Then burped politely in a tree.

The children turned. The path was gone.
The woods grew darker. Night came on.
Then Gretel cried, "I smell a cake!"
Said Hansel, "Good. I need a break."

And there before their startled eyes
Stood something of enormous size:
A house of sweets, with biscuit walls,
And sugar-glass in window halls.

The roof was iced. The door was fudge.
The chimney leaned with caramel sludge.
The pathway glittered, pink and bright,
With jellybeans and Turkish delight.

Now children, please take this advice:
A house that looks too sweet and nice
May hide a nasty sort within,
With hairy moles upon her chin.

But Hansel shouted, "Look at that!"
And ate a corner of the mat.
Then Gretel, not to be outdone,
Bit off a piece of sticky bun.

They munched the windows, licked the door,
And nibbled half the kitchen floor.
Then out there popped a smiling face
That did not quite improve the place.

"My darlings!" croaked the wrinkled dame.
"I'm very glad you children came.
Come in, come in, don't stand outside.
I've lovely beds and cakes inside."

Her smile was sweet. Her teeth were not.
Her eyes were beady, black, and hot.
Her hat was bent, her nose was long,
And something smelt distinctly wrong.

She fed them buns and treacle tart,
Then grabbed poor Hansel with a start.
"You'll do," she cackled. "Plump and neat.
A little thin, but still quite sweet."

She locked him in a tiny cage,
Then stomped about in witchy rage.
"And Gretel, you shall scrub the floor,
Then peel potatoes, then scrub more!"

Each day she cried, "Now show your finger!
Let's see if you're a tasty zinger."
But Hansel, clever little lad,
Held out a chicken bone instead of his hand.

The witch felt this and shrieked, "Too thin!
There's hardly any meat or skin!
More cakes! More buns! More custard pies!
I want him plump before he fries!"

Now Gretel watched and planned and thought,
"This witch is meaner than she ought.
She'll cook my brother, then cook me.
That is a most unpleasant tea."

At last the witch yelled, "Thin or fat,
I've had enough of this and that!
The oven's hot. The fire is red.
I'll roast the boy with gingerbread!"

She turned to Gretel. "Check inside.
Climb in and see if it is wide."
But Gretel blinked and shook her head.
"I don't know how," the child said.

"You foolish girl!" the witch snapped back.
"You crawl in there, just mind the rack!"
"I'm still confused," said Gretel, shy.
"Please show me first. I'll watch and try."

The witch bent down to demonstrate,
Which was a very poor choice of fate.
For Gretel gave one mighty shove—
And in went Witchy, hat and glove!

The oven door went CLANG! and shut.
The witch yelled something rude like "Tut!"
Then all was quiet, except the bread,
Which rose quite nicely overhead.

Young Gretel found the cage's key
And set poor Hansel quickly free.
They searched the house and, what a shock,
Found gold inside a biscuit box.

There were pearls in jars and rings in tins,
And silver spoons for witchy grins.
They packed a bag, then packed one more,
And tiptoed out the candy door.

They found their way through field and foam,
And marched directly back to home.
Their father cried and hugged them tight,
Quite sorry for that woodland night.

Their stepmum saw the gold and jewels,
And said, "My dears! I've been a fool!"
But Gretel said, "You certainly have.
Now kindly go and take a bath."

So Hansel bought a loaf of bread,
And Gretel bought a feather bed.
Their father promised, "Nevermore
Will kids be left on the forest floor."

And as for witches, let us say:
Avoid their houses on the way.
For sweets are lovely, cakes are fine,
But not when someone wants to dine…
On you!
The end